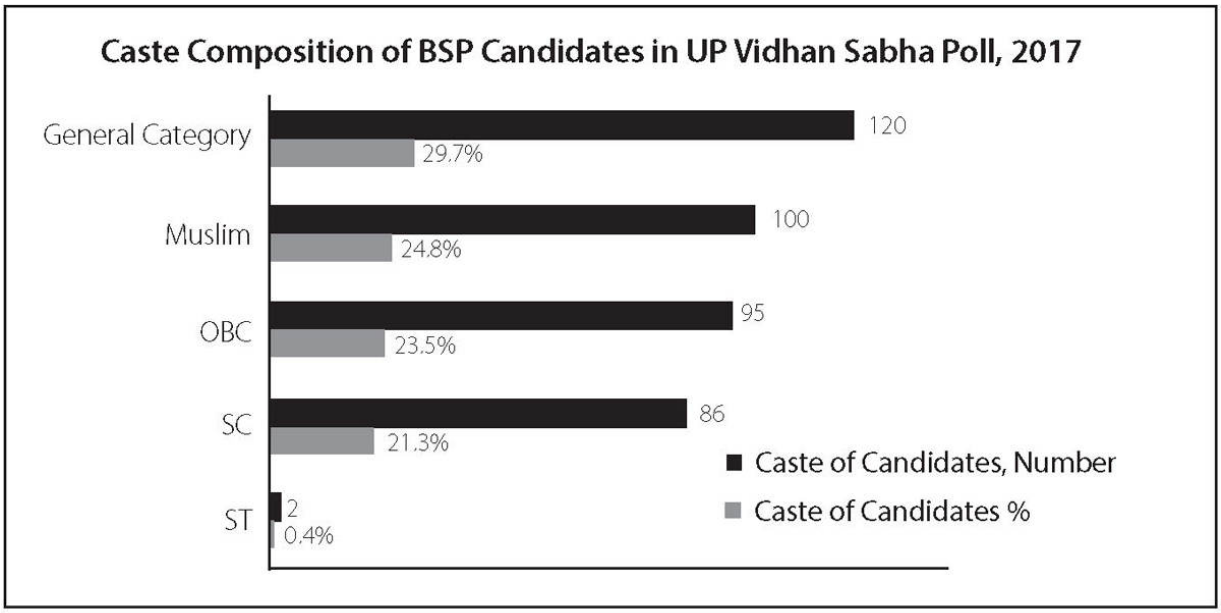
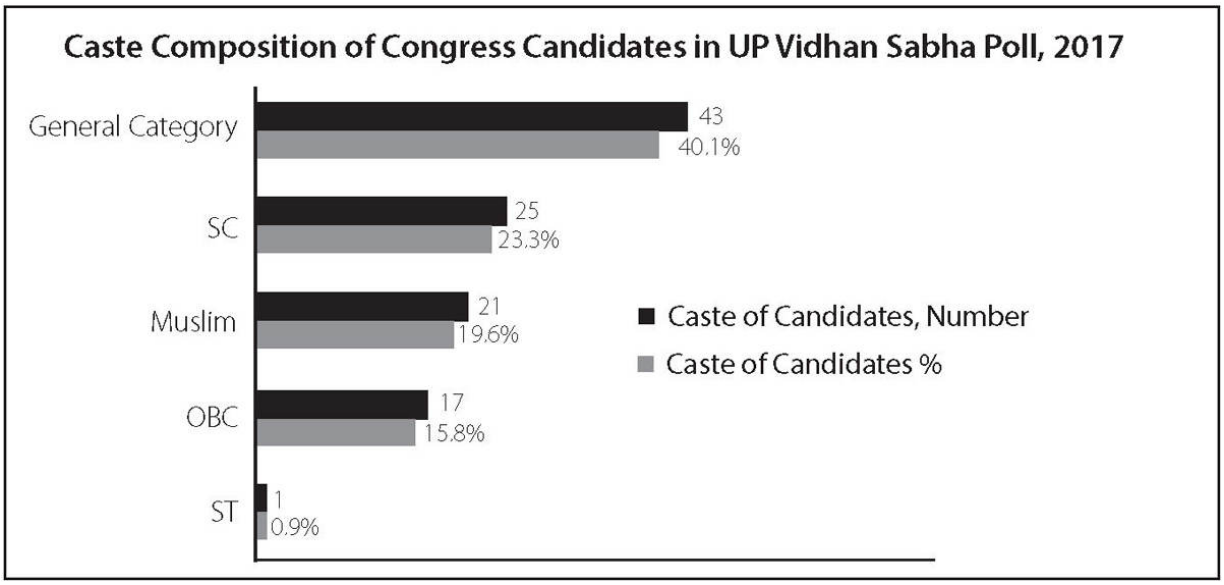




Source: Fieldwork and analysis by Mehta-Singh Social Index, using ECI data.
Note: BJP list includes 20 candidates fielded by its allies. Of these, 80% were OBC, SC or ST (8 OBC, 7 SC and 1 ST).

Nishads, Pasis and Suheldev's Resurrection: The BJP's Systematic Dissection of the OBC/SC Vote

Crucially, even as the BJP started shifting towards OBCs, it focused on sub-groups within this broader category that had earlier received less attention. This is significant because OBCs comprise as many as seventy-six different castes (such as Kurmis, Rajbhars, Nishads